

Cheesecake

A customer story, about a minute and a quarter. Deadpan testimonial, filmed at an aquarium before it opens.

The principle. Rhodri works at an aquarium and has always wanted to talk to the dolphins, so he asked Code Overlord to build him an app that does it. It works first time. The dolphins just don't want to talk to him.

Why it is funny. We can hear the dolphins, subtitled, and he never can. They know exactly what Code Overlord has built for him, and they would rather he thought it was broken.

12 March 2027. An aquarium, before opening. Rhodri at the edge of the dolphin pool: a laptop on a folding table, a speaker on a cable in the water.

"Eleven years I've worked here. Every day I've wondered what they're saying. So I asked Code Overlord to build me something that talks dolphin."

On the laptop: DOLPHINTALKER.COM.

"Hello. My name's Rhodri."

The speaker clicks and whistles. Underwater, two dolphins, subtitled.

"Is that him?"

"It's him."

"That's Code Overlord, that. It'll work."

"He's always been annoying, him."

"He does the voices at feeding time."

"He does the voices."

A pause.

"I don't want to talk to him."

"Say something daft. He'll think it's broken."

"Like what?"

A long pause. "Cheesecake."

The speaker, in plain English: "Cheesecake."

"It said cheesecake."

He tries again.

"What's it like, being a dolphin?"

CHEESECAKE.

"Are you happy here?"

CHEESECAKE.

"Can you hear me?"

A very long pause. CHEESECAKE.

He goes to fetch the fish. A school party arrives at the glass, and through the speaker, to the children, in perfect English:

"Morning, kids. Lovely to see you. Don't tap the glass."

He comes back with the bucket.

"Anything?"

CHEESECAKE.

Later, to camera:

"I've wasted all my money. Code Overlord didn't work." A pause. "I'm never going to recommend Code Overlord in my life."

Underwater.

"Job done."

"Job well done."

They swim off.

Rhodri is still going as he crosses the gantry over the shark tank, the bucket of fish under his arm.

"I do not like Code Overlord. I do not like—"

He goes in. So does the fish.

"Help! Help!"

A fin. Next door, through the glass, two dolphins watch.

"Is he all right?"

"I think he just said he doesn't like Code Overlord."

A pause.

"We're not helping him."

Card. Nothing after it.

What a Code Overlord user sees, and nobody else does. One sentence typed into Code Overlord, and by the Friday an app with its own domain that genuinely translates a species. It works for everyone but him.

Accent. Rhodri is West Wales, carried in the grammar, never spelled out. The dolphins speak in subtitles.

Two things to decide. The children's line: keep it, because it is the one moment we see it works for everyone but him. Recommendation: keep. And the ending: the card comes down with him still in the tank. Recommendation: leave it.

Rewritten from DH's two voice notes of 19 September 2026, at his length.